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Male Illustrated Storytelling U16

Life Community School, BEAC03

Jonah

In the times of the Bible, Jonah was considered one of the twelve minor prophets. They each had their own book in the Bible, and Jonah's was a story teaching us about the universal power of God. It all began with a simple command from God to Jonah. "Go to the great city of Nineveh and preach against it, because its wickedness has come up before me." said God. Jonah, who was stubborn, instead went the opposite way of Nineveh.

He frantically packed his bags and ran far to the dock, hoping that God wouldn't see him trying to escape. Eventually in the dock, Jonah found the "jackpot"; a boat going all the way to the far western city, Tarshish. He boarded the ship and lay down as he finally "escaped" God. Suddenly, the clouds started to roar, the winds began to rush through, and the waves crashed violently.

God had sent a storm to remind Jonah that He's always watching. Soon the other sailors cast lots and decided that it was Jonah's doing, he brought the storm! The other sailors then violently threw Jonah off the ship, and as Jonah was about to sink to the abyss, God sent a miracle. The miracle this time was a huge fish, resembling a whale, but it really wasn't. The fish swallowed Jonah up and now Jonah was in one sticky and smelly situation.

For three lonely days Jonah spent his hours in what should have been Jonah's watery tomb. But this time, God let Jonah live to see if he would finally repent his sins. Eventually, desperate Jonah shockingly prays to God, not saying that he's sorry, but thanking God for not abandoning him throughout the days in the gassy fish's belly and promising to always obey God from that point on. God heard his

prayer and was very pleased, so he sent the fish to go near a coast and vomited Jonah out to the sandy beach, covered in fish gunk and mystery goo.

While God did forgive Jonah, He was still quite skeptical, so He sent another command to Jonah, “Go to the great city of Nineveh and proclaim to it the message I give you.” This time, Jonah obeyed God and complied with the request. Soon enough, Jonah arrived at the grand, massive, picturesque city of Nineveh. In his one day in Nineveh, he communicates God’s message to them, that Nineveh will be destroyed in 40 days. The sermon was very short, barely lasting 10 seconds. It was missing a lot of information.

Eventually, God caught on to Jonah’s plan and completely turned the tables on him again! Despite the original message Jonah gave to Nineveh being about destroying Nineveh, God forgives them this time because somehow, the “evil pagans” had proved to be better people than God’s own prophet.

When Jonah heard this news, he was beyond furious and quickly said another prayer. In his prayer, he tells God how the first prayer he gave inside the whale was genuinely because he knew that God was merciful and loving, but this time, he also throws back a previous verse as now an insult to God and prays that God would kill him because he’d rather die than live with a God who forgives his enemies. God replied with a question asking if all this was justified but Jonah ignores the question and leaves to rest on a hill, waiting for God’s next move.

God sends a vine to shade Jonah in the sunny hill and for once, Jonah was pleased with God’s doings. Unfortunately for Jonah, God sends a worm to start eating up the vine till there was no shade. Jonah clearly gets mad again and asks God to just kill him. God asks the same question whether this all is justified before Jonah finally answers that it is absolutely justified and asks one more time to God to just kill him.

From this story, we learn that God is omnipresent, He can see you anywhere, wherever you

are, even when you're hiding, so we cannot hide anything from Him. Lastly, we also learn that even God loves those who sin, or his enemies, and we should do the same.